

RAVI SAHANI

The Shiv Nadar Foundation has invested
Rs 75 crore in VidyaGyan.

VIDYAGYAN Bulandshahr

GIVING HOPE A CHANCE

Standing in front of the new 20-acre campus, Anjali Kumar, 11, is awestruck. "I'm actually going to study here," she exclaims. The daughter of a farmer in Uttar Pradesh's Shahjahanpur district, she always dreamed of becoming a doctor, but never thought it would come true given their financial situation, until she became part of the 200 students adopted by VidyaGyan. The Bulandshahr-based school has been set up by the Shiv Nadar Foundation in partnership with the Uttar Pradesh Government and is the brainchild of HCL founder Shiv Nadar and former cabinet secretary TSR Subramanian. The charitable institution thoroughly studies how rural children cope with their external environment once they graduate from school. "Even if these children make it to the IITs or IIMs, they are socially excluded. They don't know how to dress or use western toilets, so they are made fun of. This will build their confidence," says Roshni Nadar, 27, executive director and CEO, HCL Corporation, who is driving this initiative. For admission, a child should belong to a rural area, study in a government school, be a Class V examination topper in the UP Board and the family's income should be under Rs 1 lakh a year. These students also undergo an aptitude test. Entrants will be given everything, from clothes to toiletries. Roshni is working on another VidyaGyan in Varanasi. "The next IIT or IIM topper may well be our alumnus," she beams.

by Nandini Vaish

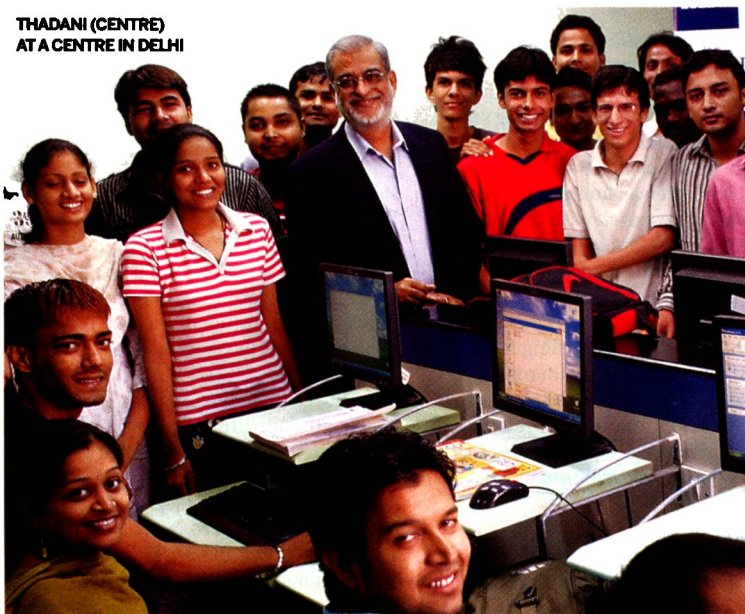
ROSHNI (CENTRE) IS
ENSURING A BRIGHT FUTURE
FOR THESE STUDENTS

dustry asking for the required manpower. "We aimed to enrol this group of unemployed graduates and convert them into software professionals," says Thadani. With Rs 1 crore, of which Rs 15 lakh was from personal savings, and a team of about 40, they set up the first centre in Mumbai. With no policy supporting the import of software in India in 1982, Pawar worked with the government to draft its first software policy in 1984. NIIT went international in 1992 and crossed a cap of \$1 billion just five years later. In 2004, NIIT Ltd and NIIT Technologies emerged as separate entities on the stock market. Its latest addition is the NIIT University in Neemrana, Rajasthan, aimed at providing industry-linked curriculum.

by Purvi Malhotra

NIIT had a turnover of over **Rs 1,100 crore** for the year 2008-09.

THADANI (CENTRE)
AT A CENTRE IN DELHI



SUBIR HALDER